

FLAT CHAT

September 2009



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FLAT CHAT *September 2009*

JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
(ABN: 87 630 303 136)

AHOC Club meetings are held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, Park Road, Rydalmere on the 2nd Wednesday of each month, commencing at 8pm. Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner at the bistro from 6:30pm.

Flat Chat is the official publication of the Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc. Contributions from members are welcome, however the Club accepts no responsibility for the accuracy, reliability or opinions of any article or correspondence herein. The Club's postal address is:

AHOC (NSW) Inc,
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

Email:
austinhealeynsw@ozemail.com.au

Website:
www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

Contributions for the magazine can also be emailed to the editor at:
allanwhitehouse@inet.net.au

IMPORTANT REMINDERS

AHOC Concours	Sun 11th October
Fruit Loop Run	Sat 31st October
Club AGM	Wed 11th Nov
Observation Run	Sun 22nd Nov
Xmas Dinner	Wed 9th Dec
2010 Fees due	December 2009
(Form on back of address insert sheet)	
Presentation B'fast	Sun 17 Jan 2010

Front Cover

The beautiful black over red 3000 Mk11 BT7 of Lynne and Henry Krzemien, pictured here at Snow Gums Boardwalk above Charlottes Pass, in the NSW Snowy Mountains

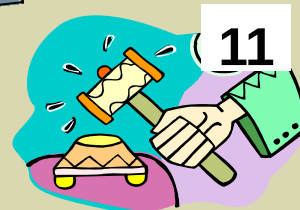
Inside this issue

Feature Stories



HEALEYS RETURN TO BONNEVILLE
Patrick Quinn pens the latest newsletter on this most historic event

NOTIFICATION OF CLUB AGM
Business to be transacted, committee positions to be elected, plus nomination and proxy voting forms



THE BURCHS CHUCK A WOBBLY"
or how *John and Kate* managed to find a happy balance on a drive south



A TRIP IN A BJ8 NAMED "RUBY"

Enjoy a most interesting trip through country NSW as told by an American Healey-driving visitor

Regular Articles

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Club Committee 2009

Club Patron

Ross Bond

Please do not call committee members after 9:00pm

President

Steve Shepard

2 Opus Place Mt Pleasant NSW 2749

☎ 4729 0452 ✉ stevesah3000@internode.on.net

Vice President

Terry Bancroft

PO Box 3027 Llandilo NSW 2747

☎ 4777 4883 ✉ bangers@bancroft.id.au

Secretary

Alan Mitchell

35 Goodacre Ave Winston Hills NSW 2153

☎ 9639 9450 Mob 0412 898 656

✉ mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Treasurer

Jim Phillips

✉ phillipsjames@optusnet.com.au

Social Secretary

To be advised

Editor

Allan Whitehouse

83 Hilly Street Mortlake NSW 2137

☎ 8765 8708 Mob 0418 477 962

✉ allanwhitehouse@inet.net.au

Competition Secretary

Patrick Townshend

☎ Mob 0407 075 997

✉ chopperpat@yahoo.com

Historian

Joe Armour

5/150 Abbotsford Rd, Picton NSW 2571

☎ 4677 3999

✉ sebring@illawarra.hotkey.net.au

Membership Secretary

Christine Lyttle

2 Hall Street, West Ryde NSW 2114

☎ (H) 9874 6080 (W) 9472 5116

✉ christinel@dbcassociates.com.au

Club Registration

Patrick Quinn

116 Warks Hill Rd Kurrajong Hts NSW 2758

☎ (BH) 9561 8749 (AH) 4567 7380

✉ p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Regalia

Richard Horwood

☎ 9764 4000 or 0408 233 592

✉ rfhx3@live.com.au

Technical Officer

To be advised

Public Relations

Richard Horwood

☎ 9764 4000 or 0408 233 592

✉ rfhx3@live.com.au

Non-Committee Positions

Competition Assistant

POSITION YET TO BE FILLED

Librarian

POSITION YET TO BE FILLED

CMC Delegates

Ray Roberts and Charles Britten

Assoc of British Car Clubs Reps

Sue Darlington/Terry Bancroft

Editor's Etchings



Here is the September issue of your club magazine *Flat Chat*.

We have lots of interesting stuff this month including the latest news on the road to Bonneville, how two of our members got out of a wobbly situation, and a most interesting American visitor's tale of touring around NSW in a BJ8.

Formal notification of the Club's forthcoming AGM is given on page 11, and includes proxy and committee voting forms, while a MEMBERSHIP RENEWAL FORM is printed on the back of the address insert sheet.

Thanks to those members who have contributed articles and photos recently - your efforts are much appreciated.

Don't forget that recent issues of *Flat Chat* can be viewed in **COLOUR** on the Club website (www.austinhealeynsw.com.au).

The Club is most grateful for the support of our magazine advertisers, and ask that you utilise their services wherever possible. When you do, remember to mention that you are from the AHOC and that you saw their advert in *Flat Chat*.

Our thanks to: NRMA Insurance, The Healey Factory, The Classic Connection, Kilmartin Automotive Sheetmetal, Cummins Classic Cars, Hoosier Tire Australia, Peninsula Sports Car Services, Nepean Classic Cars and Elders Insurance.

I hope you enjoy reading this month's magazine!

... Allan Whitehouse

There - I fixed it!!!



DIARY NOTES

Important dates to note

SEPTEMBER

Wed 9th Club general meeting
 Wed 16th "Pie in the Sky" run to Kurrajong
 Wed 16th Committee meeting
 Sat 26th Tulip Time Parade - Bowral

OCTOBER

Sun 11th AHOC Concours - Kiama
 Wed 14th Club general meeting
 Wed 21st Committee meeting
 Sun 25th Breakfast at Parramatta
 Sat 31st Charlie's Fruit Loop Run



NOVEMBER

Wed 11th Club Annual General Meeting
 Sun 15th Club Plate inspection day
 Wed 18th Committee meeting
 Sun 22nd Southern Highlands observation run and winery lunch

DECEMBER

Wed 9th Christmas Party (bookings essential for catering purposes)

JANUARY 2010

Sun 17th Presentation Breakfast - venue TBA

APRIL

2nd-5th National Rally - Victoria

SOCIAL SCENE

Details of upcoming Club activities

Wednesday 16 September – Mid-week run to "Pie in the Sky" roadhouse on Bells Line of Road, Kurrajong Heights. The owner of the restaurant of the same name at Cowan recently sold the business and opened this new "Pie in the Sky" Roadhouse. The "old" Pie continues to operate in Cowan under new management. I have spoken to the new owner of the Cowan pie and he is not a happy chappie. For convenience, I have decided to have two meeting spots. The first at 10.45 am at Wilberforce Lookout Reserve at Thompson's Corner on Castle Hill Road, close to its intersection with Pennant Hills Road. The park entrance is on Castle Hill Road. The second will be at the information centre opposite the RAAF Base at Richmond at 11.30am (we will call in and getcha). There are toilets available at both starting points. Pie in the Sky Roadhouse is located at 1858 Bells Line of Road, Kurrajong Heights (near Bilpin) (02) 4567 8921. It is situated on the **right hand side** of Bells Line of Road approximately 2.5 kilometres from the bottom of the steep hill on the western side of Kurrajong Heights. If you see the Bilpin town sign then you have gone too far! As you will have gathered they are mostly a pie shop and coffee shop with the goodies made on the premises. They also do Devonshire teas and other light treats. All members and friends are welcome. I won't tell the boss if you take a sickie. Contact for this run is Charles Britten, Ph: 9809 0498 or Mob: 0429 381 025

Saturday 26 September – Tulip Time Parade in Bowral. Parade commences at 2pm through Bong Bong Street Bowral. Austin Healeys should meet at marshalling area in Banyette Street at 1pm. At 2pm the parade will travel to Bowral Street to gain entry to Bong Bong Street, the head north on Bong Bong Street, turn right into Merrigang Street and dispersing left into Bendooley Street – finishing at Corbett Gardens and a sausage sizzle at Bradman Oval by Lions Club. (See page 10)

Sunday 11 October – Our annual Concours d'Elegance will be held at Black Beach Reserve, Kiama – entry via Shoalhaven Street between 9am – 3pm. If interested in attending this event please complete the attendance form in this issue

and return to the postal box asap.

Sunday 25 October – Breakfast at Lake Parramatta Café, Bourke Street North Parramatta starting at 9am. Austin Healeys could travel from all areas from around Sydney to meet at the Café at 9am. Starters from north, south, east and west could travel in convoy to the event – starters from these areas contact me and we can make a suggested starting point for other members to meet you. Numbers will be required for this event and the breakfast can be ordered off the menu on the day.

Saturday 31 October – Fruit Loop Run – phone Neil Thew if interested in this week long run.

Sunday 15 November – Club Plate Inspection Day at Richard Horwood's place.

Sunday 22 November – Observation Run – Southern Highlands. This run has been organised by Karyn & Barry Birch and Karen & Alan Coles and will start from Mittagong Information Centre at 10am and approximate run time is 2 hours and will finish at a local winery for lunch and prize giving. Numbers are required to ensure enough seats are reserved for lunch – please contact Karyn & Barry Birch if wish to attend or place your name on the list at the general meetings. If you wish to join the convoy from Sydney meet at the truck stop between Liverpool and Campbelltown at 8.30am for departure at 8.45am.

Note: The cost for this lunch is \$24.50 and must be paid to the AHOC on or before the AGM on Wed 11th November.

(See page 10 for more details on this run - Ed)

Wednesday 9 December – Christmas Party at Rydalmere Bowling Club commencing at 6.30pm – numbers are required.

At the last General Meeting we asked for any members who would like to hold the Presentation Breakfast in January 2010 and Barry & Karyn Birch have offered their home for this event. Stan & Jill Goodwin offered to hold the event though did express that maybe it would be nice to be held in the southern area so that all members from the south could attend. Maybe one year on the Central Coast and then the next year in the Southern Highlands would be a good idea.

Happy Healeying

Christine Lyttle

I want to die without an enemy in the world ... I plan to outlive all the bastards!

... Sir Jack Brabham

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Steve Shepard Club President



In last month's report I mentioned that we required someone to co-ordinate our 2009 Concours d'élégance. I wasn't exactly overwhelmed with responses(!) however Stephen Clark has now volunteered to perform the task this year. We've already had indications of a strong turn-out of cars and several people have indicated they'll travel to Kiama on Saturday to be ready the following morning for the display. I hope the weather's kind to us.

A couple of months ago we introduced Biggles events for members with cars on Conditional Registration. Essentially it was suggested that members could drive their cars independently to any destination of their choosing without any prior advice of a specific start time/end time etc. This is NOT possible. Therefore to ensure members don't contravene the Conditional Registration rules the Biggles events will not be permitted. This doesn't prevent members from attending an event that may not be listed in our magazine provided they contact either Patrick Quinn, Christine Lyttle or Alan Mitchell beforehand to 'log' the details.

While I'm on the subject of cars on Conditional Registration, the inspection day will be held at Richard Horwood's home on Sunday 15 November. Neville Stirton will again carry-out the inspections.

Patrick Quinn spoke at the August General meeting about the 2008 Year Book. I understand that some members aren't interested in the Year Book however a lot of effort has gone into producing the 2008 book. It contains many interesting articles from our colleagues around Australia as well as documenting members' names and the cars they own. For several years, due to publishing costs, the Year Book has been copied to disc and members who wanted a copy have had the option of viewing it on disc or printing their own copy. If you're interested in receiving a hard-copy of the Year Book, please contact me and we'll obtain quotes for producing a limited run of books for our members. We're hoping that a lower resolution copy of the Year Book will later be on our Website.

At the August Committee meeting we discussed the benefits of offering members the choice of receiving Flat Chat on-line. This is a trend that has been developing over the past few

years. Recently I viewed the Sprite Club's magazine Sprite Torque on-line. The photographs were in excellent colour and their Club has found that advertisers don't object and many members are happy to receive their magazine in this way. While I used to keep old copies of Flat Chat, I now throw them in the recycling bin after a couple of months. If adopted, members could still receive their mailed copy of the magazine if they don't opt for the on-line version. This is simply a suggestion. Feedback?

Earlier this year Ruth Hartill-law from Elders gave an informative talk at a General meeting about the company's Classic Car Insurance policy. Several members found the premiums were competitive and took out new policies. Elders were recently taken over by QBE. Although they have maintained the Classic policies, unfortunately Ruth is no longer employed.

In last month's magazine I mentioned that Lawrie Sellers established a new lap record at the final Oran Park historic race meeting in his Austin-Healey 3000. The following month at Oran Park, at the Festival of Sporting Cars meeting Club member Peter Jackson (who had never raced on the long circuit) eclipsed the previous lap record in his Austin-Healey 3000 by almost two seconds! See Patrick Townshend's Competition report for more details.

I'd like to thank everyone who attended our Supersprint at Wakefield Park, whether as a competitor or most importantly as part of the team necessary to run this event. Unfortunately the day prior to this event I was firmly advised not to attend due to a medical issue.

I'll see you at the September meeting. ... **Steve Shepard**



Don Hardie has uploaded his 100 technical articles onto the internet.

It's mainly 100 stuff but there are some things which will be of interest to 6 cylinder owners.

The download URL is: -

<http://tinyurl.com/100-Tech>



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NEWSLETTER



USA: here we come!



Photo by
Patrick Quinn

The Streamliner and the Endurance Car on display in front of Steve Pike's Factory.

Dear Healey Enthusiasts,

In the next few Newsletters we will go into detail in all the individual Venues that the cars will attend in the coming months. In order to have the most of you informed about what is going to happen, we thought it would be good to mention as many details as we can. In this Newsletter we start with the first event in chronological order.

The All British Field Meet in Portland, OR.

We would like to emphasize the fact that the return to Bonneville event is a revival of the events of 1954. As such we would like to encourage all of you to be dressed as in the 50's. A separte Newsletter about this will be sent soon.

Your Healeys return to Bonneville Team.

THE EVENT SCHEDULE

September 4-7, 2009, Portland International Raceway

All British Field Meet

12 September 2009 : Miller Motorsportspark

Display of the record Cars, BBQ,... Admission + BBQ : 15 USD

16 - 19 September 2009 : World of Speed, Bonneville Utah

See the Healey Endurance Car and the Streamliner in action on the Salt 55 years after the original event. (USFRA Admission : 10 USD per day or 20 USD for the Event.)

16 September 2009 : Wendover Revival Roundtable

Q&A with the original Team Members involved in Healey Speed records



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4 - 7 September 2009 : All British Field Meet Portland International Raceway, OR

Celebrating the Accomplishments of Donald Healey!



The first Event on American soil where both the Endurance Car and the Streamliner will be shown to the public, will be the All British Field Meet (ABFM) 2009 in Portland, OR. This event will take place during Labor Day weekend.

If you will visit the website (www.abfm-pdx.com) you can get quite a lot of information about the event, its history, past photograph galleries and the venue.

The venue is the Portland International Raceway (PIR). This year the ABFM will be the 33rd iteration. More importantly to you this year will be that Austin Healey is the featured marque so it is especially timely and meaningful that our team and both the Endurance Car and the Streamliner will be on display along with a large number of other Healeys.

Each year a different British marque is featured and the Austin Healey Club of Oregon, is the host marque club for 2009. The Club has worked with the larger overall ABFM Committee and are planning to have several dozen Healeys on special display representing an example or two of each of Donald's series, i.e., BN1 through BJ8, Sprites, Jensens, etc. Including race cars and modifieds.

These cars and the Streamliner and Endurance Car will all be on display on a grassy, tree lined area of the PIR. In addition to the specially selected Healey models for the main display there will be a large number of other Healeys on display along with several hundred other British sports cars, special interest British cars and motorcycles. It is hard to know exactly how many Austin Healeys will be present but last time Healeys were the featured marque there were over 100 on display.

The event will run for four days, September 4 - 7, 2009. The main car show will be all day Saturday, September 5th. Simultaneously, a racing event will also be held. The Society of Vintage Racing Enthusiasts (SOVREN) will be holding the Columbia River Classic races Saturday through Monday on the PIR racetrack.

This should give you plenty of reasons to attend this Event! Spectators must pay a small fee of \$10 for a day pass, or \$20 for a weekend pass. Children under 12 are free with an accompanying adult.

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Continued on page 9

Flat Chat Funnies



After retiring, I went to the Social Security office to apply for Social Security.

The woman behind the counter asked me for my driver's license to verify my age. I looked in my pockets and realized I had left my wallet at home. I told the woman that I was very sorry, but I would have to go home and come back later.

The woman said, 'Unbutton your shirt'. So I opened my shirt revealing my curly silver hair.

She said, 'That silver hair on your chest is proof enough for me', and she processed my Social Security application.

When I got home, I excitedly told my wife about my experience at the Social Security office.

She said, 'You should have dropped your pants. You might have gotten disability, too.'

And then the fight started.

Since English singer Susan Boyle has been on TV there's been a marked drop in suicide bombings.

Apparently, a lot of the terrorists didn't realise what a virgin looks like.



Such Wealth!

Silver in the Hair

Gold in the Teeth

Stones in the Kidneys

Sugar in the Blood

Lead in the Feet.

Iron in the Arteries

And an inexhaustible supply Of Natural Gas.

We never thought we'd accumulate such wealth.

INTERESTING FACT #27

***Some lions mate over 50 times a day
(Damn! I had to go and join Rotary!)***

I went to a dinner party last night, where I, and other guests, enjoyed copious amounts of alcohol.

I awoke this morning not feeling well, with what could be described as flu-like symptoms; headache, nausea, chills, sore eyes, etc.

From the results of some initial testing, I have unfortunately tested positive for what experts are now calling Wine Flu.

This debilitating condition is very serious - and it appears this is not an isolated case.

Reports are flooding in from all around the neighbourhood of others diagnosed with Wine Flu.

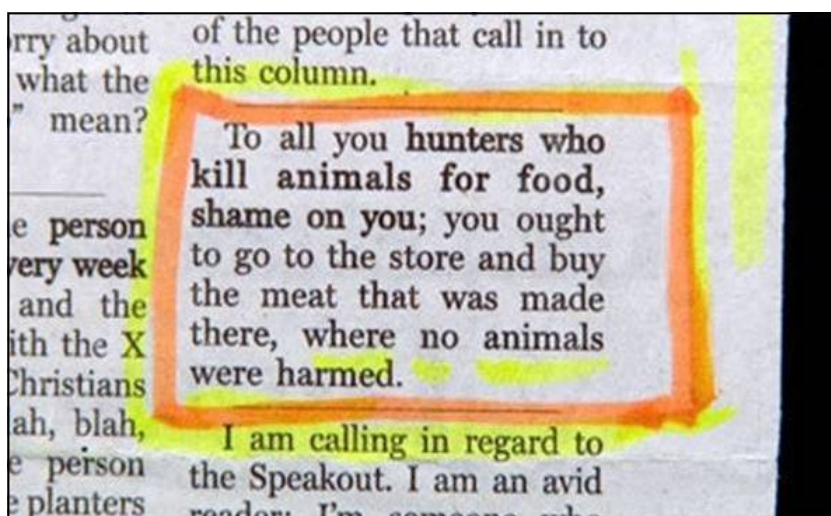
To anyone that starts to exhibit the aforementioned tell-tale signs, experts are recommending a cup of tea and a bit of a lie down.

However, should your condition worsen, you should immediately hire a DVD and take some Nurofen [Nurofen seems to be the only drug available that has been proven to help combat this unusual type of flu].

Others are reporting a McDonald's Happy Meal can also help in some cases.

Wine Flu does not need to be life threatening and, if treated early, can be eradicated within a 24-48 hour period.

If not, then further application of the original liquid in similar quantities to the original dose has been shown to do the trick.



Just remember as you read this, this person probably drives AND votes! And may have already reproduced...

World's Shortest Fairy Tale

Once upon a time, a guy asked a girl 'Will you marry me?' The girl said, 'NO!' And the guy lived happily ever after and rode motorcycles and went fishing and hunting and played golf a lot and drank beer and scotch and had money in the bank and left the toilet seat up and farted whenever he wanted.

The end

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Alan Mitchell - Club Secretary

Meeting opened at 8:10pm

Apologies: John & Caroline Kent, Craig Sheppard, Colin Goldsmith, Mike Szewczyk Doug & Pam Ross, Diana & Stuart McColl, Sue Darlington

President:

- Richard Horwood suggested to the members that he takes the surplus regalia to Bonneville with him and return the proceeds to the club – this proposal was then raised by the President to the members presents as a suggestion and this was accepted and the recommendation was agreed to by the members present.
- Wakefield Park AHOC CSCA round was very good event.
- Annual Inspection Day Sunday November 15 2009
- Social events are now updated on the website
- Shannons Eastern Creek 23/8
- "Biggles event" as recorded in the magazine are to be suspended until the Committee get a ruling on the event
- Concours 11 October at Kiama – Stephen Clark will be coordinating the Concours.
- Elders Insurance has now been taken over by QBE and will be run as a separate business. Ruth Hartell-Law is not working for Elders or QBE Insurances.

Vice President:

Brass monkey run 19/7, \$1,092.50 proceeds for the Club's charity sold

Secretary:

Other Club magazines: Healey Torque (NZ-July 2009); Australian sporting Car Club Inc News July 2009; Sidescreen TR Register Aug/Sept 09; Morgan Ear Aug 09; Ballina District Vehicle Restorers Club Inc Aug 09; Healey Torque (AHOC Qld) Aug 09; Hundreds & Thousands (AHOC Vic Aug 09); Healey Marque – AHC of America Aug 09; BMC Leyland Australia Heritage Group newsletter July 09

Inwards Mail & events:

- Reflect Effect Car Detailing & Tinting North Rocks & Pen-nant Hills
- Royal Automobile Club of Australia membership application and outline of function and club services
- Shannons Eastern Creek classic outline of event and location of AHOC cars to Area B and parade 4:00pm
- Burwood Show & Shine Sunday September 20 2009 10am & until 5pm last chance entry closed 21/8/2009
- Alpine classic Rally entry form – 17/18 October 2009
- Graham Gittins – "Terribly British Day Sunday December 6 Patrick White Lawns near National Library of Australia Canberra entry free - contact Graham on 02 6288 5238 for more details
- Tatlers' Breakfast Run from MX5 Club to Tatlers' Wines Hunter Valley Sunday 27 September 2009 – information contact Secretary cost of breakfast \$25/head registration prior to 20 September application form from Secretary



Minutes of the general meeting held on Wed 12th August 2009

- Email from Mark Ariansen requesting informant to assist with the purchase of an Austin Healey with automatic gearbox (mark is disabled vet and wants to purchase an Austin Healey – suggestion from the members that a Borg-Warner automatic gearbox can be fitted as replacement for the existing gearbox.

- Chevalier College Highlands Motorfest Moss Vale Road Bowral 25 October 2009 Entrants \$10 per vehicle gates open at 7:00am – enquiries 0438090263 Healey categories fort show are Gold Original Unrestored; Blue Pre 1960 classic Red 1960-1980 Classic; Brown Racing Cars – applications from Secretary

Treasurer:

- Bank balance \$7,500 cheque account \$75,000 in cash management account plus the funds from CSCA round and Brass Monkey Run
- CSCA Round estimated profit \$4,000
- Charlie's Fruit loop run proceeds

Social:

- Calendar July to December on website
- Check out the rest of the social events as listed in the magazine

Editor:

- Articles and photos to Editor by 15th of the month to meet the magazine deadline.
- Any old magazines with relevant Healey articles or articles of interest to members – please send the original articles so that Allan can scan them into the magazine- the original articles will be returned.
- Also photos taken at club events can be emailed or posted to the Editor for inclusion in the magazine.

Competition:

- Morgan Supersprint
- FOSC Laurie Sellers set a new lap record at Oran Park, & Peter Jackson set a lap record for Healey in Group Sa

Historian:

- Story covering Healey links to Jim Clark & Sally Stokes, Jeff Sikes Warwick Banks & Graham Hill
- Steve Pike and the Streamliner and the Endurance Car update have left Australia bound for USA and Bonneville
- Bonneville Updates will be presented in the Flat chat magazine.

Regalia:

- Just Cars – advertise request Committee to consider
- Also include Club on Australian Classic Cars website
- Club Stickers will be available next meeting

Club Rego: Year Book – available – any interested parties wanting a copy of the Year Book contact either Patrick Quinn (details in the magazine) or the Secretary

Club Rego no activity this month

continued on page 23

The old and the new

Having a Revival is about re-experiencing Events that took place in the past, 55 years to be more precise. It is about trying to recreate the same kind of atmosphere and emotions.

This of course involves some research into things which have little to do with the cars. That it is, due to current Bonneville Racing regulations, not always possible to copy the old and proven ways.

The dilemma it brings up is : do you copy the old in a new package or do you make it obvious that it is new and only refer to the old? The latter was the choice that was taken for one of the Race helmets. The new helmets need to be Snell 2000 approved. Needless to say, leather helmets do not comply. As such we bought an almost futuristic looking helmet and had it painted in car colours with some add-ons. Up to you to judge the end result...



The 1954 helmet



The 2009 helmet that will be used racing the Endurance Car. During the race on Phillip Island in Australia, one Car Magazine referred to the helmet in an article and was wondering whether "the Stig" was wearing new colours!?

Media Information

For high resolution photos of the cars please contact publicity@healeysreturntobonneville.com

WWW.HEALEYSRETURNTOBONNEVILLE.COM



CONCOURS D'ELEGANCE Sunday 11 October 2009

**Plenty of Time.....
to clean my Healey!!!**



At: Black Beach Reserve, Kiama
Entry via Shoalhaven Street
Time: 9.00am – 3.00pm

The reserve has shaded areas if you wish to have a picnic otherwise cafes and hotel are close by for lunch. We will have access to electricity and will have coffee and tea available during the day.

If you wish to display your Healey please complete the form on page 20 of this magazine and return to the club post box: PO Box 2754 North Parramatta NSW 1750 as soon as possible.

OBSERVATION RUN IN THE BEAUTIFUL SOUTHERN HIGHLANDS - SUNDAY NOV 22ND

Mark this date on your calendar as it promises to be a really enjoyable Healey outing driving through the beautiful countryside of this area. Along with the written instructions of the route you should follow there will be questions to be answered and for each correct answer you will be awarded points, so the passenger must remain alert. We estimate the run to take about 2 or 2¼ hours. This is really a fun challenge and a chance to work as a team. Prizes will be awarded, so let your competitive spirit come to the fore. However, cheats will not be condoned, so if you open the sealed envelope you will accrue big penalty points. This envelope will contain our final destination in case you get completely lost and give up.

Win lose or draw, you will receive a gourmet lunch at a winery at a cost of \$24.50 per person. It will be a set menu and I will need to know numbers for lunch 2 weeks prior to the event.

Please note: Payment for this lunch must be made to the AHOC on or before the AGM on 11th November.

Just to whet your appetites I have listed the menu below (I must add, Barry and I have lunched there twice now and the food is very, very good and the atmosphere is great and we will have the venue to ourselves so you can make as much noise as you like). Also you are invited to take the opportunity to do a wine tasting while you are there. \$2 per person redeemable on purchase of wines.

Lunch will consist of:

Jackeroo Platter as an Appetiser

Home made Terrine

Wensleydale Cheese

Triple smoked Prosciutto – from Poachers Pantry Canberra

Smoked Ham – from Poachers Pantry Canberra

Honeyed Pickled Onions

Dried Fruits

Chutney

French Sourdough Bread

Gourmet Pie and Salad

These will be Steak or Lamb served alternately

A Suitable Summer Sweet

Pots of Tea and Plunger Coffee will be available at an extra cost

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CONTACT: Barry or Karyn Birch

Email: karyn.birch@bigpond.com

Phone: 4861 2096

NOTICE OF ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

The Annual General Meeting of the Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc will be held on

Wednesday 11 November 2009

at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, commencing at 8:00pm.

The business to be transacted includes:

1. To receive, consider and adopt the financial statements of the Club that were published for the financial year ended 30 June 2009 (as tabled in the September 2009 Flat Chat magazine) ;
2. To elect office bearers for the year January to December 2010;
3. To transact any business that maybe lawfully brought forward;
4. To confirm the minutes of the Special General Meeting held on Wednesday 13 May 2009.

Note: the accounts for the financial year ended 30 June 2009 should be read in conjunction with the Treasurer's Report which is published in this issue of Flat Chat.

Alan Mitchell
Secretary.

COMMITTEE POSITIONS AND CURRENT (YEAR 2009) OFFICE BEARERS.

President	Steve Shepard
Vice President	Terry Bancroft
Secretary	Alan Mitchell
Treasurer	Jim Phillips
Social Secretary	Vacant
Competition Secretary	Patrick Townshend
Editor/Public Officer	Allan Whitehouse
Historian	Joe Armour
Membership Secretary	Christine Lyttle
Club Registrar	Patrick Quinn
Regalia Officer	Richard Horwood
Technical Officer/Club Equipment	Vacant
Public Relations	Richard Horwood
Spare Parts Secretary	(position merged with Tech Officer Role)

Additional (non-Committee) positions

Billeting Officer	Christine Lyttle
Conditional Registration Inspector	Neville Stirton
Librarian	Vacant
Assistant Competition Secretary	Vacant
CMC Delegates	Charles Britten and Ray Roberts
Association of British Car Clubs representatives	Sue Darlington and Terry Bancroft

COPY of the Special General Meeting Minutes tabled in June 2009 Flat Chat magazine

Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW (Inc)) Minutes of the Special General Meeting held on 13 May 2009 at Rydalmere Bowling Club

Meeting opened at 8:00pm

Apologies – Steve Shepard

Chairperson – Terry Bancroft

Secretary – Alan Mitchell

The motions as tabled in the recent copies of the Club's April and May 2009 editions of Flat Chat magazine were recapped:

Motion 1:

That the Club approve the additional membership category of "Associate" Members as -

1. Financial members who have not currently nor previously owned a vehicle of the Marque;
2. Financial members who would not have any constitutional voting rights in the Club;
3. Financial members who would not be eligible to undertake any committee position; and
4. The other requirements of the Club's Constitution as outlined in part II -

Motion moved by John Kent and seconded by Charles Britten

Motion 2:

1. That the Club approve existing club members' ability to include their other marque vehicles as eligible vehicles under the Club's Conditional Registration provisions of the Constitution; and
2. These other marque vehicles if driven on the road will need to be certified roadworthy under the requirements of the Roads & Traffic Authority Conditional Registration requirements. Conditional Registration Inspection and roadworthiness certification of these other marque vehicles will be the individual member's responsibility and cost and will not be eligible to form part of the Club's registration and inspection day; and
3. The Associate Member or Member would need to provide evidence of financial status of the Club to the Club's Registration Officer and proof of inspection and certification as to roadworthiness of the other marquee vehicle to enable the Club to certify eligibility to RTA Conditional Registration.

Motion moved Colin Rule and seconded Neville Stirton

Two questions were raised prior to the vote being taken:

1. Were all the members present financial members – this was reviewed by the Membership Secretary who confirmed that all present were financial members.
2. The clause referred to in the advice concerning the approval level of the "members present" to approve the motions.
 - The Secretary advised that the clause referred to in the distribution referred to a general motion at a General Meeting requiring 75% minimum approval to pass the motion, however the minimum requirement to pass a motion to change the Club's Constitution is not less than two thirds (66.67%) of the financial Members present.
 - The primary requirement for these motions to be passed is the 66.67% majority as contained in the Club's Constitution Clause 37 which reads:

"The Constitution and Statement of Purposes of the Club may be amended at a General Meeting or Special General Meeting of the Club provided that:

- Notice of motion to amend the Constitution and Statement of Purposes is fully stated in the official publication "Flat Chat" and circulated at least one month before such motion to amend the Constitution is moved.
- Each assignment duly moved and seconded is passed by a majority of not less than two thirds of financial members present at a special meeting called for that purpose."

Note: For voting on motion 1 there was 1 abstention and for the voting on motion 2 there were 2 abstentions. There were no postal or fax proxy votes received after 5:00pm 12/5/2009.

NB To gain a result there is a requirement for a 66.67% majority in favour of each motion.

Each motion was defeated having not reached the required majority in favour.

Having completed all the matters the Special General Meeting was closed at 8:15p.m.

Chairperson: Terry Bancroft

Secretary: Alan Mitchell

	Total	Voting Summary				Total
		Motion 1		Motion 2		
		In Favour	Against	In Favour	Against	
No of attendees at Special General Meeting votes	38	20	18	28	9	37
No of postal votes received prior to 5:00pm 12/5/09	5	5	0	4	1	5
No of fax votes received prior to 5:00pm 12/5/09	12	3	9	3	9	12
Number of eligible votes participating in SGM	55	28	27	35	19	54
Result of the count	100%	50.9%	49.1%	64.8%	35.2%	100%

FORM OF PROXY

AUSTIN HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) Inc.

I,

being a financial member of the Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc appoint
for the Annual General Meeting to be held on 11 November 2009

.....
a financial member of the Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc. to hold my proxy in
respect of the election of the Committee or to vote in accordance with my nominations.

Signed Dated

NOMINATION FORM

AUSTIN HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) Inc.

Annual General Meeting

11 November 2009

Committee Nomination

I,

being a financial member of the Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc nominate
the following member(s) for election to the 2010 Committee.

Name

Position

Name

Position

I have obtained permission from the nominees for this nomination.

Signed Dated

AHOC - ANNUAL FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

Balance Sheet

As of June 2009

18/08/2009
9:06:30 PM

Assets		
Current Assets		
Prepaid Event Expenses	\$500	
Advances & Floats	\$0	
Pre-paid 2008 Rally Expenses	\$0	
Cash		
Main Bank Account	\$7,551	
Cash Management Trust Account	\$75,085	
Spare Parts Inventory	\$590	
Regalia Inventory	\$200	
Non-Current Assets		
Property Plant & Equipment	\$5,457	
Less: Accumulated Depreciation	-\$2,449	
Main Cheque Account	\$0	
Undeposited Funds	\$0	
Voluntary Withholding Credits	\$0	
ABN Withholding Credits	\$0	
Trade Debtors	\$0	
Total Assets		\$86,933
Liabilities		
Current Liabilities		
Charitable Donations Provision	\$410	
2008 National Rally Reserve	\$0	
Prepaid Charlie's Run	\$0	
Other Event Prepayments	\$160	
Supersprint Expense Provision	\$0	
Misc Unpresented cheques	\$150	
GST Collected	\$0	
GST Paid	\$0	
Voluntary Withholdings Payable	\$0	
ABN Withholding Payable	\$0	
Total Liabilities		\$720
Net Assets		\$86,213
Equity		
Opening Balance	\$0	
Members Funds	\$86,939	
Current Year Earnings	\$0	
Retained Earnings	\$11,484	
Current Earnings	-\$12,210	
Historical Balancing Account	\$0	
Total Equity		\$86,213

Profit & Loss [With Last Year]

July 2008 through June 2009

18/08/2009
9:00:31 PM

	This Year	% of Sales	Last Year	LY % of Sales
Income				
Advertising	\$1,960	5.9%	\$4,036	3.7%
Competition				
Wakefield Park	\$0	0.0%	\$16,115	14.9%
Donations	\$411	1.2%	\$778	0.7%
Interest Received	\$3,821	11.6%	\$4,434	4.1%
Magazine Subscriptions	\$80	0.2%	\$0	0.0%
Members' Subscriptions	\$9,055	27.5%	\$7,750	7.2%
Raffles & Auctions	\$802	2.4%	\$1,184	1.1%
Regalia				
Regalia Sales	\$988	3.0%	\$150	0.1%
Social				
AHOC Christmas Party	\$0	0.0%	\$770	0.7%
All British / Shannons Eastern	\$135	0.4%	\$115	0.1%
Brass Monkey Run	\$0	0.0%	\$6,253	5.8%
Charlie's Runs	\$10,136	30.7%	\$9,190	8.5%
Other Runs	\$0	0.0%	\$1,000	0.9%
Miscellaneous	\$2,015	6.1%	\$0	0.0%
Spare Parts				
Anniversary Dinner	\$3,570	10.8%	\$0	0.0%
Photo & Poster Sales	\$0	0.0%	\$30	0.0%
Rally Regalia	\$0	0.0%	-\$1,171	(1.1%)
Rally Deposits	\$0	0.0%	\$54,362	50.3%
Rally Sponsorship Payments	\$0	0.0%	\$2,490	2.3%
Rally Raffle Income	\$0	0.0%	\$650	0.6%
Total Income	\$32,974	100.0%	\$108,135	100.0%

THE SILICON CHAUFFER

The Stanford Racing Team is Stanford University's response to the DARPA Grand Challenge.



The Grand Challenge is an off-road robot competition devised by DARPA (Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency) to promote

research in the area of autonomous vehicles. The challenge consists of building a robot capable of navigating 132 miles through desert terrain in less than 10 hours, with no human intervention.

Cars that can safely drive themselves - at least across the Nevada Desert - came a step closer in October 2005 when a very clever VW Touareg, affectionately named 'Stanley', was the first robot vehicle to complete the 132-mile course set up by the US Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA).

Kitted out by a team from Stanford University, California, with a range of gizmos including GPS, laser range-finders, radar, inertial sensors, three video cameras and no less than seven Pentium M laptop computers, Stanley finished the \$2 million challenge race in 6 hours and 54 minutes - 3 hours, 6 minutes under the race's 10-hour limit. Stanley's average speed through the obstacle-ridden and mountainous course was 19mph.

Profit & Loss [With Last Year]

July 2008 through June 2009

18/08/2009
9:00:31 PM

	This Year	% of Sales	Last Year	LY % of Sales
Expenses				
Increase in Expense Provisions	-\$14,317	(43.4%)	\$7,141	6.6%
Credit Card Charges	\$313	0.9%	\$1,827	1.7%
Affiliation Costs	\$1,303	4.0%	\$1,433	1.3%
Bank Charges	\$5	0.0%	\$35	0.0%
Concours Expenses	\$0	0.0%	\$50	0.0%
Display Days	\$0	0.0%	\$300	0.3%
Donations & Flowers	\$1,650	5.0%	\$723	0.7%
Filing Fees	\$45	0.1%	\$44	0.0%
Insurance	\$436	1.3%	\$0	0.0%
Regalia Purchases	\$4,320	13.1%	\$0	0.0%
Magazine & Year Book	\$11,423	34.6%	\$7,004	6.5%
Name Tags/ meeting expenses	\$920	2.8%	\$800	0.7%
Raffle Expenses	\$0	0.0%	\$14	0.0%
Postage, Printing & Stationery	\$130	0.4%	\$362	0.3%
Internet & Web Site Costs	\$935	2.8%	\$730	0.7%
Trophies	\$301	0.9%	\$524	0.5%
Xmas Party	\$3,984	12.1%	\$3,606	3.3%
Presentation Day	\$28	0.1%	\$240	0.2%
Anniversary Dinner	\$12,462	37.8%	\$0	0.0%
Supersprint Event				
Supersprint - Circuit Hire	\$5,650	17.1%	\$1,000	0.9%
Supersprint - Fire Crew	\$250	0.8%	\$200	0.2%
Supersprint - First Aid	\$550	1.7%	\$0	0.0%
Supersprint - Timing	\$0	0.0%	\$385	0.4%
Supersprint - Radios	\$264	0.8%	\$264	0.2%
Supersprint - Other	\$1,500	4.5%	\$1,671	1.5%
Social Events				
Breakfast Runs	\$268	0.8%	\$0	0.0%
Miscellaneous Events	\$1,052	3.2%	\$1,125	1.0%
Brass Monkey Run Expenses	\$0	0.0%	\$4,600	4.3%
Charlie's Run	\$11,536	35.0%	\$9,850	9.1%
CMC Display Day - Eastern Ck.	\$150	0.5%	\$120	0.1%
2008 Rally				
Salamander Bay Accommodation	\$0	0.0%	\$280	0.3%
Rally Expenses	\$25	0.1%	\$44,952	41.6%
Rally Refunds 2008	\$0	0.0%	\$72	0.1%
Rally Meals	\$0	0.0%	\$4,600	4.3%
Rally Entertainment	\$0	0.0%	\$2,700	2.5%
Total Expenses	\$45,184	137.0%	\$96,651	89.4%
Net Profit/(Loss)	-\$12,210	(37.0%)	\$11,484	10.6%

THE BURCHS CHUCK A "WOBBLY"

John and Kate have bad vibrations on a recent run

The WWWH Story

(or Wobbly Wire Wheels on Healeys)

Last Friday Kate and I set off in the trusty BT7 to visit friends in Bowral on Friday night before going on to help out at the super sprint at Wakefield on Saturday.

Alas, we only just got off King Georges Road onto the M4 and accelerated up to 2500 revs in top overdrive and felt the front wheels starting to vibrate. As soon as I went faster the wheels started to wobble frantically and the front end felt like it was going to drop on the ground. A pneumatic drill had nothing on my steering wheel!

Fortunately my friend in Bowral owns a recently beautifully restored MGB and he had told me about a place in Bowral that can balance wire wheels on the car. A frantic phone call to my mate and he arranged for us to take the car to this guy on Saturday morning before we went to Wakefield.

I can tell you, that driving all the way down the expressway at 80 k in a 110 zone was a testing time for yours truly but we made it eventually! (Kate even got to see some scenery on this trip!)

Now this place in Bowral is: Bowral Tyrepower, 41 Karkham Rd Bowral. The guys name is Ian McCrae and his contact number is 02 48611355. A very nice and helpful guy who

paces a small rotary engined touring car.

Initially we removed all 4 wheels and checked to see if they were running true, as wire wheels have a tendency not to be anywhere near perfect in this regard. 2 wheels

were spot on and 2 were not so perfect. He balanced them all on his standard machine (he has fittings for machine spinning spoke wheels) and then we put the 2 good ones on the front and the other 2 on the back.

He has this fascinating machine that he sits on and it has a drive wheel which is placed against the outside tyre wall to spin it up to various speeds and this shows up the balance issues for wheels, hubs and brake rotors.

Although apparently perfectly balanced off the car, they were not too flash on the car. To start with the bonnet was jumping up and down like crazy and the bumper bar was vibrating and shaking while the car tried to jump off the jack stands. However, after only 10 minutes on each side, placing weights and fine tuning the position and size of weights, all the vibration was gone.

Fantastic.. I can now do 140 quite easily with no vibration at all (of course I would only EVER do 110!!!) and the car feels fantastic.

If you do have The WWW syndrome on your Healey and lousy wheel balance with your wire wheels I recommend you give Ian a call and get him to give them the treatment. It works better than any wheel balance I have ever seen and the cost was very reasonable. It will transform your car I can assure you!

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A TRIP IN A BJ8 NAMED "RUBY"

Rob Warren from the USA gives his impressions of driving through NSW

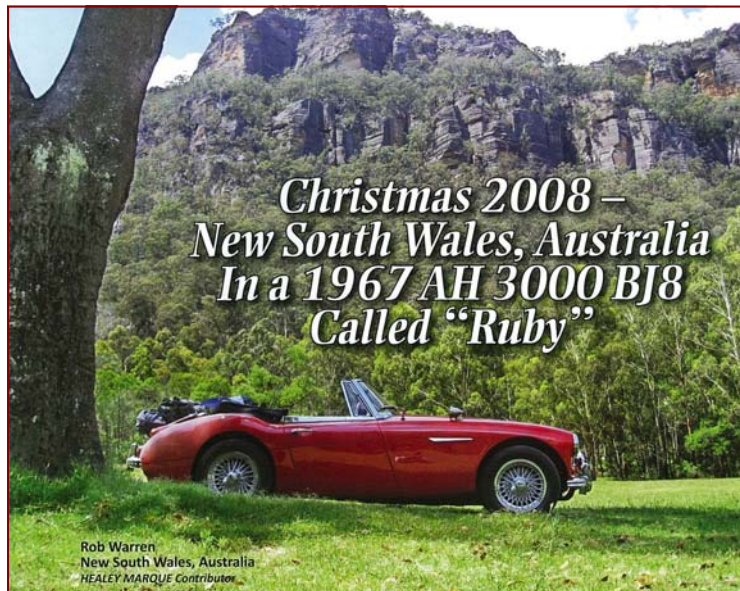
Day 1 - Sydney to Newnes

I was up at the crack of dawn (or "sparrow's fart" as it's affectionately known here) on Christmas Day, having packed up the spares and tools the day before and I drove around the corner to my neighbours' apartment where-upon I was greeted with a slap-up breakfast of poached eggs, toast and avocado and a whacking great cup of tea before hitting the road. Top down, sun shining, and my iPod cranking my favourite tunes out of Sydney, heading west towards the Blue Mountains. The Christmas presents I'd bought for Ruby were a GPS unit and a new stereo which I tested quite thoroughly in the first few hours!

In fact, all the way to, over and down the other side of the mountains, the speakers coped extremely well with the inevitable noise that comes from an old car doing 100 KPH with the top down. I had been hoping to stay at a friend's farm near Oberon, but as it was all locked up at Christmas and there was no way of getting the keys to me, my plan was to aim for the second camping area I'd looked at and simply spend two nights there instead of one.

For a Christmas morning I was a little surprised by the lack of traffic on the roads; it's normally busy in and around Sydney, but this year was an extremely pleasant exception. What other road users there were produced a great many waves and thumbs-up though, which always puts a smile on my face. I noticed the temperature drop-

Reproduced from the June 2009 issue of **HEALEY MARQUE**, courtesy of the Austin-Healey Club of America



ping rapidly as we climbed higher into the clouds up in the mountains and a combination of the car starting to lag on the steep climbs, the oil pressure dropping, the rain starting and most importantly, the driver bursting for a wee, signaled the time for the first unscheduled stop of the day.

I figured out why she was lagging a little when I pulled over - I'd forgotten to take her out of "overdrive" on the steep climbs. I'm not so smart sometimes.

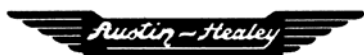
While answering the call of nature I noticed the steam rising from the tarmac and also saw breath and I admit to being surprised that only two hours from Sydney in mid-summer, Ruby and I were already in the colder climbs. I think it's something that people rarely realise about Sydney until they've been here - when the coast is

30 degrees C, 30 miles west and away from the sea breezes, the temperature will be up to 40 degrees C and then further west into the mountains where I now found myself scent-marking a speed limit sign, it was cold enough for me to need a sweater.

I checked the oil level and it was down a tiny bit, but nothing significant so I threw in another pint or so and hoped for the best. The pressure remained a little low but still within the safe operating range, so I figured I'd get to my destination and then dig out the workbooks and see what they say. The oil pressure is the dial I look at more than any other these days since an unfortunate incident involving a spun big-end bearing

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in the #6 cylinder while coming back from Canberra in April (and the subsequent engine rebuild). That little gauge is the source of significant paranoia, on my behalf.

I put the top up and prayed for working wipers and better weather on the leeward slopes of the mountains and headed off again.

Within 20 miles, as if someone upstairs had heard me and turned off the tap, the clouds had parted, the sun shone and I stopped to put the hood back down and headed for Lithgow where I filled up with fuel. At this point the other road users vanished from sight and the roads were mine. I've no doubt that everyone was feasting on gargantuan Christmas barbecues, and shortly after lunchtime I turned onto the Wolgan Road, heading for the old oil shale mining town of Newnes. OK, it's not a "town" as much as it is a dirty great mine with a pub that hasn't

were getting covered in dust and then when I restarted I noticed the fuel pump complaining loudly about the state of the road.

There was nothing to do about it other than to just get to the end. patiently... which eventually we did. My back was in agony by this time - I'd broken it in four places a couple of years ago and every now and then driving in conditions like this will be the source of considerable discomfort, but there wasn't long to go now according to the GPS. I stopped at the old Newnes Hotel (pub) and bought some firewood from the family that live there. It's no longer a hotel as nobody lives within miles and miles, but they organise camping and National Park walks and the like for tourists who come out that way during the dry months.

I continued towards the very end of the road, at last able



to enjoy some shade that I was receiving courtesy of the beautiful gum trees at the side of the road. The forest was pretty thick here and the sounds and smells were beautiful. Permeating delicately through the utterly satisfying Healey scents of petrol, oil and leather were incredible citrus and wild flower traces which were a pleasant change from the previous two hours of dust and dirt! The cicadas in the trees were making an impressive racket and I

been used since the 1930s. What I didn't know though, was that the tarmac stopped and my destination lay at the end of 15 miles of gravel and dirt. Not a big problem for Ruby necessarily, but the nature of the road itself was badly rutted and full of hard bumps all the way.

Now most SUV or "Chelsea Tractor" drivers wouldn't have noticed this and could happily have driven at 30 or 40 MPH down this road, but Ruby and I were unable to get out of second gear for the next two hours. The heat was intense to the point that I had to put a hat on for some shade and the poor old girl was being shaken to pieces. At one point I stopped to pack away a few things that

found myself noticing the wildlife change with the onset of the change in canopy. I stole fleeting glimpses of a couple of goannas the size of horses. For the uninitiated in Australian wildlife, a goanna is a type of monitor lizard - a carnivorous reptile growing up to two metres in length. That crazy bugger Steve Irwin would have loved it here, rest his soul.

I then came upon a little creek which needed to be forded. I grabbed a stick from the side of the road to test the depth and it all looked OK. The dirt wasn't too soft and there were plenty of very small rocks, so Ruby and I crawled down to it and then drove through the shallowest

part with no problems. Up on the other side, the track suddenly broke free of the dense forest and led into an enormous escarpment of grass, lined by tall gum trees and surrounded further back by incredible rock walls which gave the place the effect of a spectacular natural amphitheatre that was quite breathtaking.

The best thing about my arrival here was that there was only one other vehicle. I'd not really known what to expect. Would there be dozens of families with dreadful, screaming kids, or nobody at all? While it was reassuring to have someone else around in case of a problem or emergency, I've never had a Christmas on my own before and I was rather looking forward to a generous helping of solitude and serenity, so this was a great result.

I picked a spot and parked Ruby in the shade of a tall gum tree and opened up the hood for her to cool off after her long journey in the heat. Having checked that all the engine bay fittings weren't shaken to smithereens, and then after setting-up my tent, I prepared plenty of wood for the fire and sorted out my water and supplies for dinner. Then all that was left for me to do was to put down my chair, pour a big glass of wine and get stuck into a good book while the afternoon sun beat down.

A few more cars arrived as I cooked up a large sirloin steak for my dinner, but due to the size of the place I was barely aware of their presence at all for the next two days. A lovely German couple I'd met some hours before came and joined me by my fire after they'd had their dinner and we sat and had a few more glasses of wine and chatted about their trip. I hit the sack at about half eleven and slept like a baby, despite my sore back.

Day 2 - Newnes

The following morning saw me up early thanks to a couple of kookaburras in the tree above me deciding to see which of them could laugh the loudest. It was a tie, I decided, and I cooked my bacon and eggs for breakfast while pondering how a bird that size can make such a deafening noise. They're fantastic birds, kookaburras - similar in looks to kingfishers, although they have no bright colours. They're also larger and extremely inquisitive to the point of being downright cheeky sometimes.

I then realised I'd forgotten to pack the tea. What an idiot. I'm not so smart sometimes. An Englishman in the wild without tea - it just didn't feel right!

Instead of plunging into a spiral of depression though, I went for a wash in the creek that was nothing short of divine. A little further downstream from where I'd forded it on the previous afternoon, another tributary joined it and the water was deeper and flowed much faster.

I spent most of the day fixing up Ruby. The glove box lock had broken thanks to all the shaking and rattling around, and I couldn't get it open. So with a goodly supply of tools, ingenuity and some considerable and imaginative swearing, I got her open and took the lock apart and fixed it. I'm fairly new to the classic car game but I find such simple and yet complete satisfaction in figuring out a

problem, taking it apart, fixing it and putting it back together.

A lot more reading and chilling out ensued, the highlight of which was again the weather and the wildlife... wallabies (like kangaroos, but smaller), more goannas, parakeets, lorikeets, kookaburras, and of course the deposit left by the wombat from the night before who'd nonchalantly crapped right next to my tent while I was snoring away. I would have put my hand in it the following morning were it not for the daylight and fast reactions. Again for those who aren't aware, the wombat is a remarkable mammal. About the size of a large, sturdy bulldog, these little units are phenomenal burrowers and chomp away at the ground digging up roots all night long. They're a marsupial like kangaroos and wallabies, but as they spend their lives digging and burrowing, their pouch faces backwards so the young don't get a face full of dirt! Evolution, it seems, has a considerate side.

I was sitting at one point with my feet on Ruby's rear bumper, reading away, when I noticed one of the many large, jet-black crows eyeing up the car from about a hundred yards away. I watched in slow-motion as it suddenly crouched and then dropped off its perch and took flight heading straight for Ruby and me. Majestically, it gathered momentum and then I got the sudden feeling that I was a bystander watching the Dambusters' squadron coming into final formation down the Rhur Valley. "Don't you dare!" I thought... as I then realised what the bird's intentions were. It dropped a little lower and stopped flapping its wings, gliding straight towards Ruby's bonnet at an altitude of about six to seven feet. I couldn't get up fast enough and as I realised I'd never get the top up in time while shouting NNNNNNOOOOOO!, the bird flew straight up over the windscreen and with impeccable timing, deposited what I can only imagine was a good week's worth of lower intestinal payload right down the centreline of the new interior - all over the armrest, the rear seat, the hood cover and the boot, and then he climbed steeply to come to land on a branch in the tree above while looking down to admire his handiwork. The interior of the car had gone in a second from pristine beige leather to a bad day in Beirut.

If I'd had a gun at the time I'd have eaten crow for dinner. I didn't though, as weapons are not permitted in National Parks here, so I cleaned up the damage and sat back down in quiet admiration of such excellent and accurate bombing.

A fairly quiet night followed with a great big chicken curry for dinner and I spent an hour or two sitting by the fire looking up at a sky completely full of stars and watched the odd satellite tracking across the night. It's amazing how many more stars you can see when you're away from the glare of the city lights, and Orion was the brightest of all the constellations.

*(Part 2 of this most interesting journey will appear in the October issue of **Flat Chat** ... Ed)*

TECH TORQUE

Balancing Instructions for Spline-Drive Wire Wheels

(from Dayton Wheels website)

Special attention is required when balancing spline-drive (sometimes referred to as "center-lock" or "Dunlop style") wire wheels. To properly balance this style of wheel, it must be centered on the balance apparatus in exactly the same manner that it is centered on the car. The two seating surfaces that center the wheel can be seen in Figure #1. These two bevels are typically "machined" surfaces as opposed to less exact "rough-cast" surfaces. Note that the splines are used to drive the wheel, not center the wheel. Balancing spline-drive wheels by using a computer spin balancer is only effective if the wheel is centered as shown in Figure #1.

Some spin balancers have a cone set designed specifically for spline-drive wheels but these are very rare. Dayton Wheel Products spline-drive wire wheels manufactured since 1990 have a fully machined hub that allow most cones to accurately center the wheel.

Another simple but very efficient method for balancing is the bubble balancer. This method was used when the cars were new. Spin balancing on the car is another alternative. This is especially effective if the suspension system is worn or brake drums are out of balance.

A properly balanced wheel will almost always require weights on both the front and rear sides of the rim.

To test a wheel for "trueness," mount it on the cars rear spline (without a tire). Tighten the knock-off cap and spin the wheel slowly using a dial indicator pointer on the inside bead of the rim (where the tire seats). Do not check for trueness on the outer edge of the rim. When measuring a movement of 1/16" or less is acceptable. Worn threads on the cap or hub or a worn bevel on the hub or cap can make the

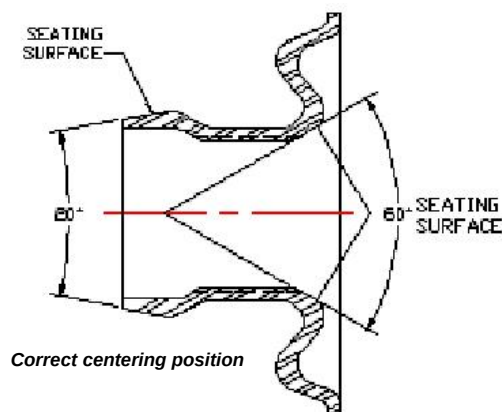


FIGURE #1

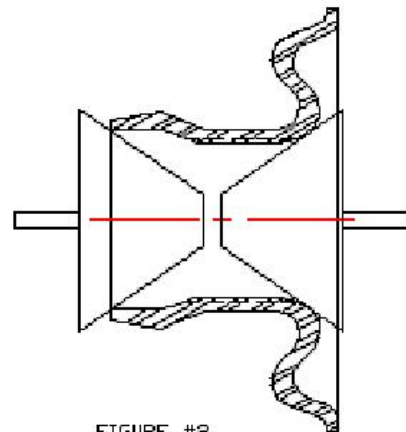


FIGURE #2

Can use for Dayton's manufactured after 1990

... continued next page

REQUESTS FOR APPROVAL OF CLUB RUNS NEW EMAIL PROCESS

The committee advises that the following process now applies for email requests to conduct club runs.

- Event requests must be received by the Social Secretary (or in lieu, the Secretary), by no later than the second Friday of the month, to enable committee review and meet magazine publication deadlines.
- The Social Secretary will determine whether or not the proposed event conflicts with any previously advertised Club event.
- Details of the request, together with the Social Secretary's recommendation, will then be emailed to all committee members for their consideration.
- Committee members will respond to the Social Secretary within 3 days.
- The Social Secretary will advise the event proposer the committee decision. If the event is approved, the magazine Editor will be advised by email, for inclusion in the next magazine.
- Should the event not be approved, the Social Secretary will advise the member requesting the run the relevant reason.

THE CLASSIC CONNECTION

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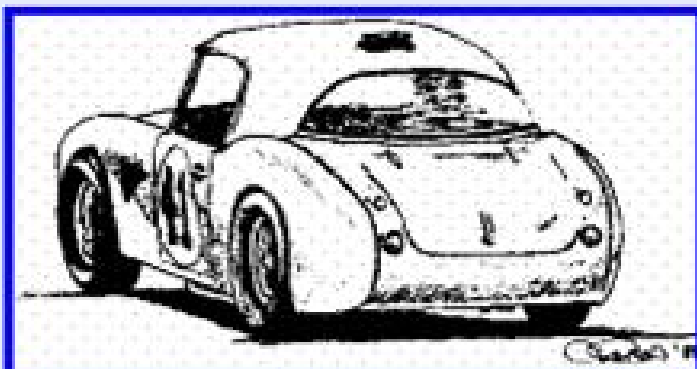
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wheel appear out of true. If the wheel appears to have excessive runout, mark on the wheel the location of the highest reading. Remove the wheel and rotate it 180 degrees and place the wheel on the same hub. Recheck for runout. If the highest reading changes position from that marked a worn part or parts are indicated. (Figure # 3)

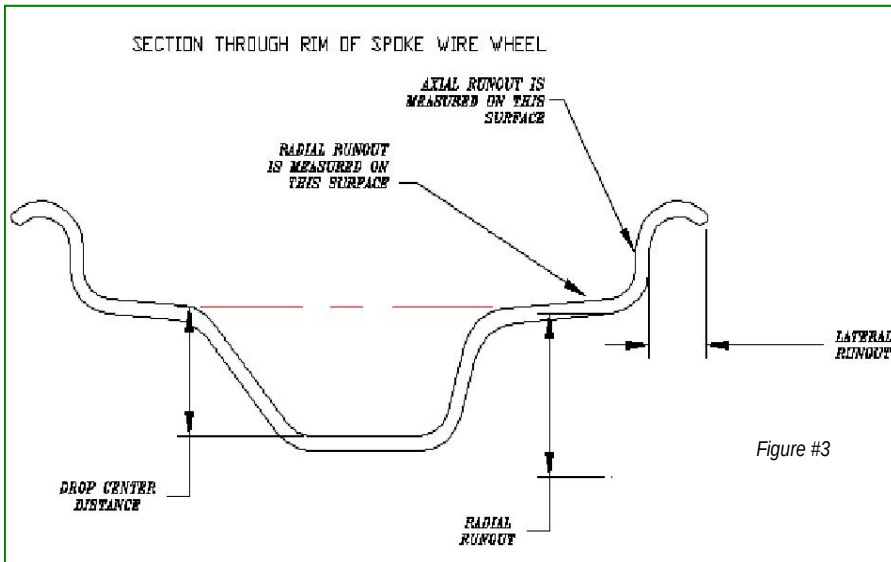


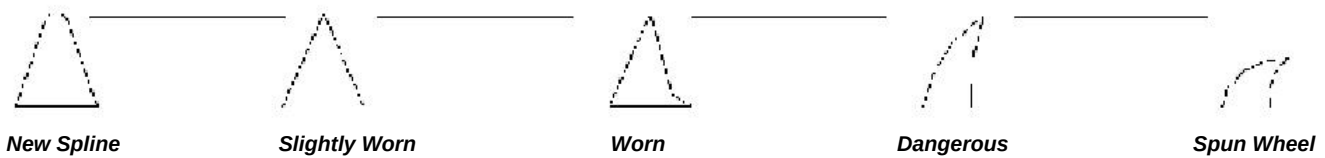
Figure #3

Worn splines on the hub of the car can quickly wear the good splines on a new wheel and vice-versa. On the hubshell of the wheel, the rear-most portion of the splines (about 3/8") will show no wear since they do not mesh with the splines on the car's hub. This allows for a visual comparison between the front-most worn splines and the rear-most unused splines (Figure #4). Fully stripped splines is a serious situation and should be resolved immediately.

Repair of worn splines is not feasible. It is quicker, easier and less expensive to replace the wheel or wheels with new spline drive wheels from Dayton Wheel Products. More information is available by calling Dayton Wheel Products Customer Service at 800-862-6000 or by visiting our web site at:

www.daytonwirewheel.com

Figure #4



MEMBERSHIP NEWS

Christine Lyttle
Membership Secretary



I will be attending the *Healeys Return to Bonneville* event in the USA and will not be back until the end of September.

However, I would encourage you to complete the 2010 Membership Renewal form, which can be found on the back of the magazine address insert sheet, and forward it to the Club PO Box. If you find it more convenient, you can pay your fees by direct debit - details are included on the renewal form.

Please also ensure that you provide FULL DETAILS of your Healey(s) so we can keep our Club records as up-to-date as possible

Christine Lyttle

When my wife and I arrived at an auto dealership to pick up our car, we were told the keys had been locked in it. We went to the service department and found a mechanic working feverishly to unlock the driver's side door. As I watched from the passenger side, I instinctively tried the door handle and discovered that it was unlocked.

"Hey," I announced to the technician, "It's open!"

To which he replied, "I know - I already got that side."



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COMPETITION REPORT

Competition Secretary
Patrick Townshend



Colin Goldsmith was the only Healey running in a depleted field.

The week before saw the Festival of Sporting Cars race meeting on the Oran Park GP circuit. Several Club members were competing including Patrick Townshend who was at the track on Friday to obtain his endorsement for taking part in

Perhaps the most important event on the AHOC competition schedule was the fifth round of the Combined Sporting Car Club Supersprint at Wakefield Park on Saturday 1 August. As this is 'our' meeting it was great to see a healthy attendance from members, particularly those who were the support team, whether controlling the flag points, pit-lane, the 'dummy-grid', scrutineering and the office. Of course the contribution of members who participated is also appreciated. We had several 'honorary members' for the weekend and Simon Gardner in his rapid and highly developed MG Midget set the fastest time of the meeting. The fastest lap time by an Austin-Healey was 1:12.1 set by Peter Jackson in his Group Sa 3000. Other members representing our Club included Colin Goldsmith, Brian Duffy, Scott Graham, Lisa Boes, Greg Denning, Chris Komor and Patrick Townshend. Michael Branson was also competing in his Austin-Healey 3000.

The following day was the All British race meeting. Although some of the fields were small, a healthy group of sports cars included Peter Jackson, Lawrie Sellers, Brian Duffy and Colin Goldsmith. Maintaining his form from Saturday, Peter Jackson was again the fastest and best placed Austin-Healey followed by Lawrie Sellers with Brian Duffy and Colin Goldsmith always close together. When the final race started, an eight lap event,

Regularity events. After successfully completing the track session with an observer, engine issues meant an early exit from the weekend's activities.

Peter Jackson was having his first race meeting on the Oran Park GP circuit. Brian Duffy was there in his Austin-Healey 3000 and Steve Shepard was racing his MGB. Pete Jackson was the fastest Healey qualifier ahead of Brian Duffy. Steve's MG suffered electrical problems all weekend and wasn't ready for qualifying. In the first race, twenty eight competitors grid-eded for the start. Peter Jackson was the fastest Club member in this race with Brian Duffy finishing in fifteenth and Steve finishing in thirteenth after starting from last.

The big news was that Peter Jackson set a new lap record for the Group Sa production sports car class. With Oran Park definitely closing at the end of 2009 this record will stand forever. Without delving into the archives, it's probably a good chance that from the time Oran Park opened as a race circuit over forty years ago there were Austin-Healeys racing at the track. It was perhaps fitting that at the final event for these cars, the Austin-Healey was still there and racing successfully!

Patrick Townshend

AHOC SUPERSPRINT REPORT

The recently completed Austin Healey Super Sprint at Wakefield Park was a great success from the Club perspective and according to the participants.

Patrick Townshend, (helped no doubt by Jacqui) did an amazing job setting the event up.

Given the nature of the event the organisation of it cannot be left to chance, as failure to have Stewards, Ambulance, Fire Brigade, Timing, Radios and Chief Scrutineer, who are mostly people outside of the Club, would not allow the event to proceed.

While these groups are important, the contribution of the Austin Healey Owners Club members is critical to the running of the event on the day. We need people to do licence checks, starting at 7.00 am Jill Dowsett, Jacqui Townshend and Carolyn Kent; members to assist the Chief Scrutineer to check the vehicles (100 or so) Keith Drake, John Dowsett, Colin Goldsmith, Patrick Townshend and others; to manage the "Dummy Grid", Ian Jensen, Patrick and Jacqui Townshend; someone to start each group, Chris Dimmock; someone to count the laps, Eric Rudd; a PA announcer Carolyn Kent, who also monitors the sign on sheets for both drivers and volunteers.

We also need volunteers to man the flag points around the track. In the past 6 years we only had to have 3 flag points. This year we were advised that we now need to have 4 flag points. This put pressure on the organisers to ensure that we had enough members and friends to man the 4 flag points in sessions of 1 ½ - 2 hours with 2 people.

For some, such as the Starter (Chris Dimmock), the Counter (Eric Rudd), Dummy Grid organisers Ian Jensen (also Chief Scrutineer), Patrick and Jacqui Townshend and the PA announcer Carolyn Kent, had no relief and manned (or should

that be "womanned?") their posts all day.

We used 19 flag marshals during the day. They were:

Neil Thew, Denis Richardson (visitor), Terry Bancroft, Don Read, Doug Ross, Pam Ross, Denis Walker, Chris Barrett (visitor), Jim Phillips, Rod Richards, Stuart McColl, Diana McColl, John Dowsett, Keith Drake, Bruce Wallace, Garry Cartwright, Peter Osborn, Jacqui Townshend and Bridget Duffy (visitor).

Many thanks to them, for their critical contribution. It is also a great way to see the spins and breakdowns at close quarters.

At the dinner that followed, the awards were presented.

1. Doug Ross – Good Bladder Control Award.
Doug was volunteered by Pam for 2 continuous shifts when we found we had problems for the last shift. He was greatly relieved when he finally returned at the end of the last shift.
2. Jacqui Townshend – Encouragement Award.
Jacqui was entered in the event by Patrick but after the early morning familiarisation laps decided that she would stick to quilting and instead helped out all day in various capacities.
3. Eric Rudd – Pet Rock Award.
We decided that the dirty crushed road base that Eric used to count laps was not appropriate for our image and presented him with polished white quartz rocks for next year.

My thanks to all the members and their friends, who so readily assisted on the day, particularly when we were required to man the fourth flag point. I will leave the results of the day for Patrick to report.

... John Kent

MID WEEK RUN TO PATONGA BEACH 18th AUGUST

These runs are just getting better and better. It was a real buzz to have 18 members and guests in six Austin Healeys and other assorted machinery attend this wonderful event. The weather was absolutely magnificent, warm and still. Just a perfect day to give your old Healey a bit of a run.

It was hard to know who travelled the furthest to the event. Was it Kath and Ian Roughley (Healey) from Newcastle or Jennifer and Warwick Sell from Springwood (Healey) or Col Goldsmith from Pitt Town (Falcon Ute Healey) who travelled to the Berowra Ferry on the way to the Berowra start only to find it closed for repairs and had to make his way back to the Pacific Highway via Galston Gorge and Hornsby, and then to the start. In my view they are all winners as were Marjorie and John Wadsworth (Healey), Margo and Don Hardie (Healey), Allan Whitehouse (Healey), Gary Bain (Healey), Muriel and Ray Roberts (and friends Barry, Bev and cousin Norm in the Merc), and the Brittens (Z car), as they all took the trouble to come along! Well done!

Patonga Beach is now the proud owner of a very new hotel. Many of us had not seen the new establishment. It is certainly worth a look. The hotel is located on the waterfront at Patonga opposite the public boat wharf. It boasts magnificent views from its large al fresco dining area and very good ale and food too! I understand that on a recent warm Sunday the hotel had to knock back 130 diners who had not booked a table! It would be enough to make me cry if I was the publican. Still I guess the fish shop next door that, incidentally does do very good fish 'n chips, laughed all the way to bank.

Our next mid week event is to Pie in the Sky Roadhouse at Kurrajong Heights (not Cowan) on 16 September 2009. Please turn to Social Scene in this issue for full details.

Cheers and CU there - Charles Britten (9809 0498)

2010 NATIONAL RALLY



2010 NATIONAL RALLY

www.healeyvic.com.au

Dear Fellow Healey Enthusiasts,

The Austin Healey Owners Club of Victoria will be hosting the 2010 Australian National Rally in Creswick, Victoria from April 2nd to April 5th 2010 and we would like to invite you to join us.

Creswick is a very scenic part of Victoria in the heart of Spa Country and the Historic Goldfields Areas.

We have managed to secure the 4½ star Novotel Forest Resort Creswick as our venue. The hotel boasts luxurious hotel rooms and suites, each with private balconies and stunning views overlooking the pool, fairway and surrounding tree canopy of the Creswick State Forest.

Joining us we have former BMC Competition Director and noted author Stuart Turner also well known Rally and Competition Driver plus author John Sprinzel.

There is a full Events Programme mapped out that will include Scenic Drives, Party Night, Display Day, Formal Dinner, Talk by Stuart Turner and John Sprinzel and the ever popular Rocker Cover Racing.

We have also included an Optional Extra Day on the Monday for those who feel the weekend is too short.

We believe that this will be a memorable Rally for all those who attend and look forward to seeing you all in Creswick in April 2010.

**For information please contact: Maressa Rowland C/O The Healey Factory,
75 Heatherdale Road, Ringwood VIC 3134 PHONE: 0421 670 315**

SPONSORED BY



PLEASE NOTE: REGISTRATION and ACCOMMODATION FORMS WILL BE AVAILABLE TO DOWNLOAD FROM THE 2010 AUSTRALIAN AUSTIN HEALEY NATIONAL RALLY WEBSITE ON SEPTEMBER 25th

2009 RACING AND GENERAL EVENTS CALENDAR

5/6 SEPTEMBER	SPEED ON TWEED	TWEED HEADS NSW
5/6 SEPTEMBER	MUSCLE CAR MASTERS	EASTERN CREEK
11-14 SEPTEMBER	MORRIS REGISTER 09 RALLY	BATHURST
13 SEPTEMBER	MERCEDES-BENZ CONCOURS	PARRAMATTA PARK
13 SEPTEMBER	SOUTH COAST VINTAGE CAR CLUB	LAKE ILLAWARRA
19/20 SEPTEMBER	HSRCA ALL HISTORIC RACING	WAKEFIELD PARK, GOULBURN
14 OCTOBER	GEAR DAY	WAKEFIELD PARK, GOULBURN
15 OCTOBER	2ND GEAR DAY (NOTE THIS IS ON A THURSDAY)	WAKEFIELD PARK, GOULBURN
16 OCTOBER	VCAA NEWCASTLE TOUR	RAYMOND TERRACE
17/18 OCTOBER	CSCA TRIUMPH SPORTS OWNERS ASSOC	WAKEFIELD PARK, GOULBURN
17/18 OCTOBER	ALPINE CLASSIC RALLY	
17/18 OCTOBER	14TH EARLY FALCON NATIONALS	PARKES
23-26 OCTOBER	BUICK EAST COAST MEET	ARMIDALE
30 OCT-01 NOV	FoSC	WAKEFIELD PARK, GOULBURN
1 NOVEMBER	ALL CHRYSLER DAY	FAIRFIELD SHOWGROUND
7 NOVEMBER	CSCA SPRITE CAR CLUB AUSTRALIA	ORAN PARK SOUTH
7 NOVEMBER	YASS VALLEY HERITAGE CELEBRATION	BANJO PATTERSON PARK, YASS
8 NOVEMBER	TWIN LAKES CLASSIC UTO SHOW 'N' SHINE	WYONG RACECOURSE
22 NOVEMBER	MORRIS AND MINI MINOR ANNUAL BIRTHDAY	PENRITH SHOWGROUND
28/29 NOVEMBER	HSRCA ALL HISTORIC	EASTERN CREEK
1 DECEMBER	2ND GEAR DAY	WAKEFIELD PARK, GOULBURN
2 DECEMBER	GEAR DAY	WAKEFIELD PARK, GOULBURN

Secretary's Report *continued from page 8*

CMC: 26/10 Forum at CMC meeting covering fuels and oils

- Proposal for new circuit at Wyong being considered by Council
- Marulan circuit is now available at cost of \$2800 + medical support for the day

Association of British Car

Clubs: No report

General Business:

- Stickers promoting the Club's website will be available next meeting
- Bonneville Newsletters being sent to Editor
- Neville Stirton is looking to stay overnight at Kiama for the Concours – any interested members please contact Neville direct.
- Bowral Tulip Festival see What's On.
- Lucky door prize: Chris Dimmock – box of chocs
- Raffle: David Cairns – DVD

- Rod Richards - bottle of McLaren Vale 2005 Merlot

- Raffle proceeds \$33.10

Meeting closed at 9:15pm

Happy Healeying – Alan Mitchell



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MARKETPLACE

FOR SALE

Advertisements in this section are free to AHOC members and are published for 3 months unless sold beforehand.

(Include a photo of your item for better impact ...Ed)

Austin-Healey 100/4 BN1 (1954)



Matching numbers vehicle, original Australian delivery March 1955. This car was restored mid/late 90's and has been serviced regularly since – runs on premium unleaded fuel, actively used vehicle, faithfully maintained.

Old English White with red interior, red soft top (hardly used only in rain/very hot days) and tonneau, has bag/cover for side curtains, runs 3 speed gearbox, 60 spoke wheels, 4 stud rear end, good tyres, period side mirrors. Has heritage certificate. The original bonnet (also O.E.W.) and other spares to be sold with the car. Historic conditional registration plates not transferable. VIN #BN1221048 Engine # 221048

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This is not a toy, not a concept car. It is a newly developed single seat car in highly aerodynamic tear-shape road-proven real car. It is ready to be launched as a single-seater for sale in Shanghai in 2010 for a mere RMB 4,000 (A\$700)!

Interested? Wait till you learn that it will cruise at 100-120 Kph with an unbelievable 0.99litre/100Km (258 mpg)!! Impressed? Totally, considering all the hi-tech and space-age material input into this car! The Most Economical Car in the World will be on sale next year Better than an Electric Car - 258 miles/gallon. From conception to production: 3 years and the company is headquartered in Hamburg, Germany. Gas tank capacity = 7 litres, Speed = 100-120 kph, Fuel efficiency = 258 miles/gallon, Travel distance with a full tank = 650km



HEALEY FIESTA IS "ALIVE AND WELL"

I was on the Internet this evening and saw that the Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) had reprinted the article from 'Road & Track' on the Healey Fiesta (page 12 of the February 2009 issue of *Flat Chat*).

The Healey Fiesta is alive and well, living in California and recently won 1st place in the "Open" class at the 2009 California Healey Week in Paso Robles, California.

I will include a photo of the car from the show as well as sending you a photo of my other Healey.

I have owned the Healey Fiesta since 2001 and drive it occasionally.

Bob Segui
1978 Healey Fiesta
1953 Nash Healey Le Mans Coupe
(see photos of Bob's cars on the back cover - Ed)

"Telling people at a dinner party you drive a Nissan is like telling them you've got the ebola virus and you're about to sneeze."

... Jeremy Clarkson

Back Cover

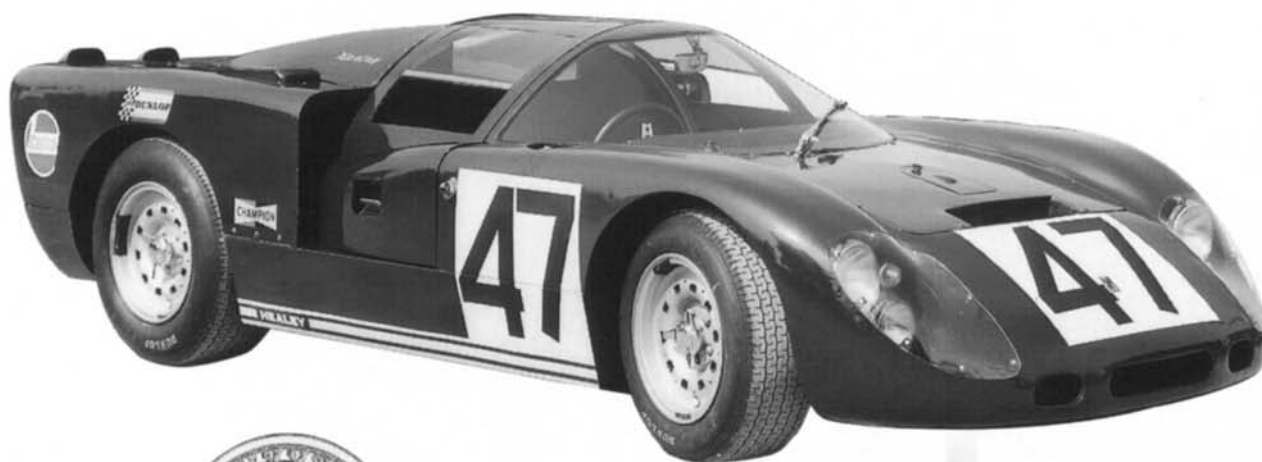
Healey Fiesta and Nash Healey of Bob Segui in the USA.
(see note from Bob above)

Photos from the recent AHOC Supersprint at Wakefield Park

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Back Page Pics



Healey Fiesta



1953 Nash Healey Le Mans Coupe



Three little maids from school are we



Greg gets advice from Sue and friend



Col displays his age



Who is this? Could it be "The Stig"?



Ecca and Chris secretly listen to their Ipods



Chris Komor and Patrick Townshend play silly buggers



John Burch, John Kent and Denis Walker come in from the cold